Colorado GMU 12 – AI Elk Scouting Package

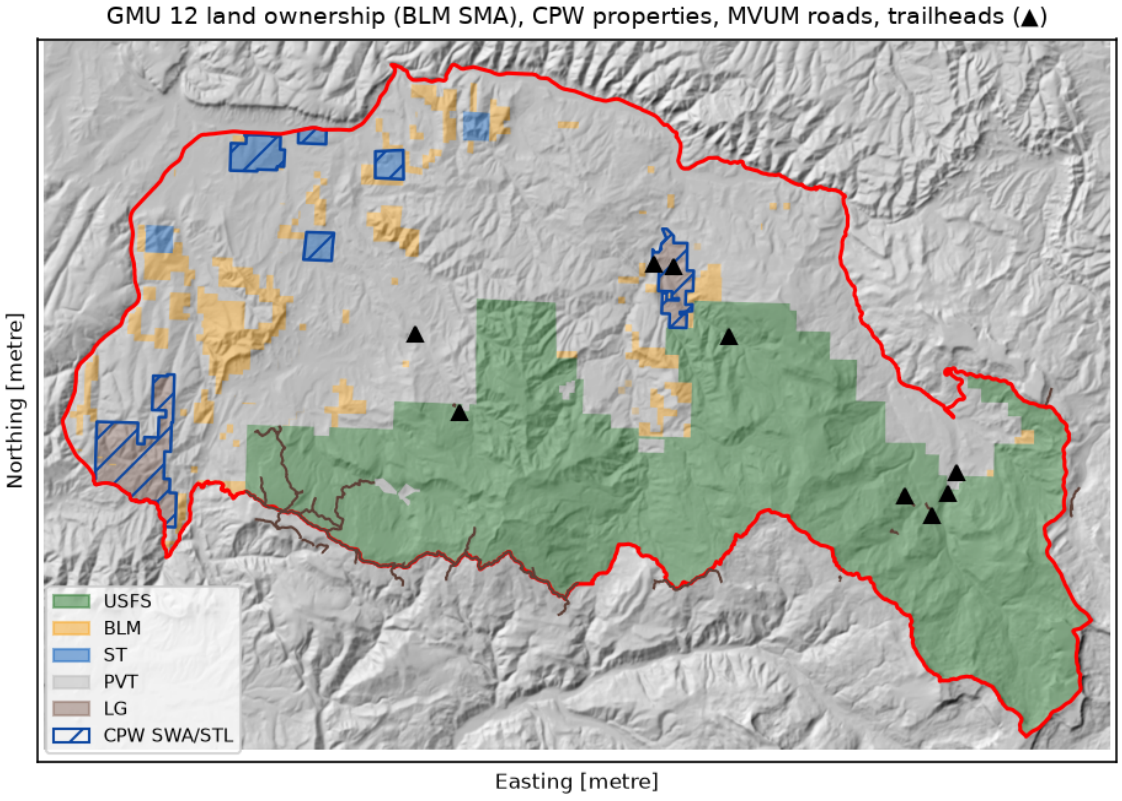
SAMPLE / PROTOTYPE · Prepared Oct 16, 2026 (v2) · All hotspot zones are **computer-model estimates** built from public data, not observed animal locations.

1. Unit overview

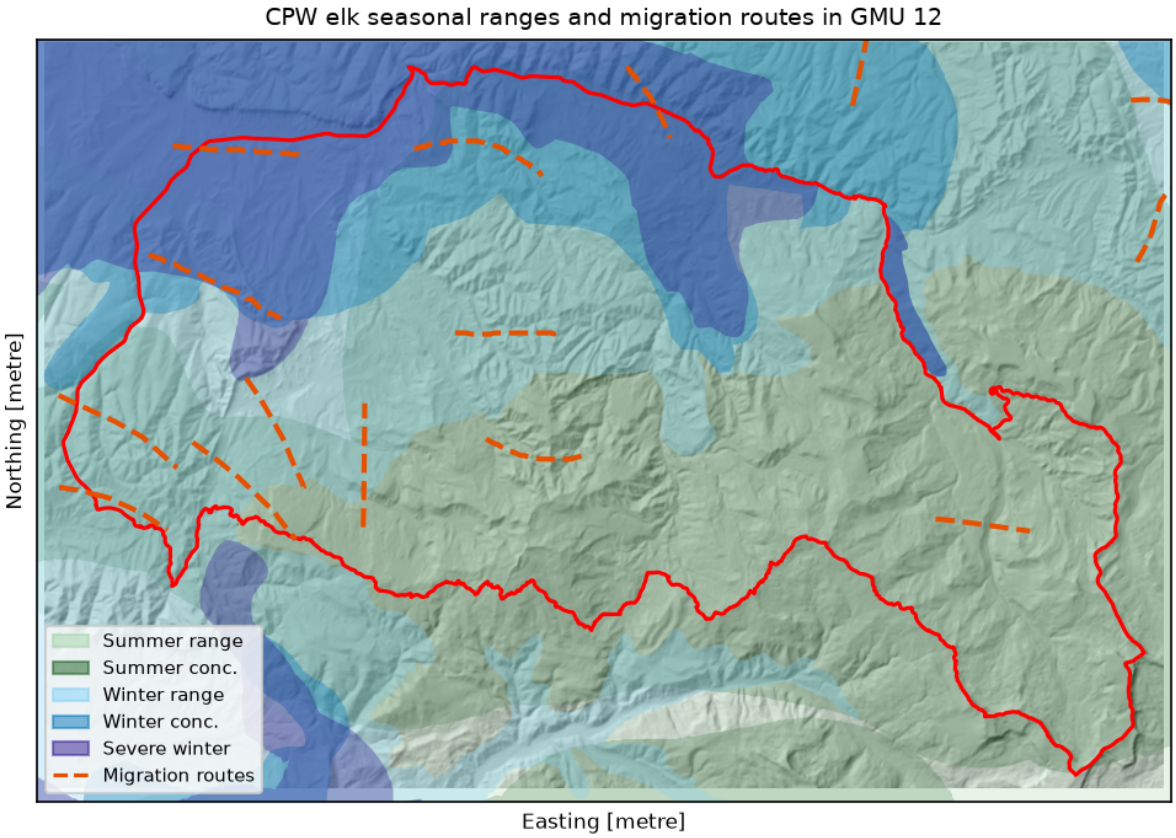
GMU 12 (CPW Big Game GMU layer) covers about **493 sq mi (315,345 acres)** in **Moffat, Routt and Rio Blanco counties**, northwest Colorado (approx. 40.03–40.37°N, 107.12–107.83°W). It sits in elk Data Analysis Unit **E-6**, which CPW's 2025 harvest report shows as the state's largest elk DAU by hunters and harvest. Elevation ranges roughly **6,217–12,004 ft** (USGS 3DEP). Named features on the USGS topo base include Williams Fork Mountains and the Williams Fork and Milk Creek drainages. National Forest land lies mainly along the south and east of the unit.

Land: about 49% federal (USFS ≈ 42%, BLM ≈ 6%), ≈ 1.4% state, ≈ 47% private (BLM Surface Management Agency layer, computed by us). Public land with legal access is concentrated in the National Forest in the south and east; the north and west are a private/BLM/state mix where access must be checked parcel by parcel. CPW-listed public-access properties in the unit: Jensen SWA, Indian Run SWA, Coal Creek Ranch SWA, and Iles Grove, Morapos Creek and Monument Butte State Trust Land parcels.

Elk habitat (CPW Species Activity Mapping): elk summer range covers ~95% of the unit and summer concentration area ~86%; winter range ~56%, winter concentration ~25%, severe winter range ~18%; CPW migration-corridor polygons cover ~71%, and CPW migration-route lines run ~74 km through the unit. In other words, nearly the whole unit is mapped elk habitat. The useful signal is *where* winter range, routes, water, cover and low road density overlap.



Elk seasonal ranges (CPW)



How to use this package: (1) load the GPX/KML into onX, Gaia or Google Earth; (2) open the web map and toggle the season heat that matches your license; (3) pick 2–3 zones near legal access; (4) glass from saddles/ridges at first and last light; (5) confirm water on the ground; (6) re-check land status and MVUM closures before driving in.

2. Draw results – 2026 Primary Elk Draw (CPW Draw Recap, report dated 5/14/2026)

Limited licenses with "012" hunt codes. "Drawn out at" = the minimum preference points that drew in 2026 (resident / nonresident); "Leftover" = licenses remained after the draw. Figures are copied from CPW's report; quotas and odds change yearly.

Hunt code	Type	Quota	1st-choice apps	Drawn out at (Res / NonRes)
EE012O1A	Either-sex, archery	550	1,136	Res 0 pts (239 of 330 at 0 drew, 72%) / NonRes 4 pts (38 of 158, 24%)
EE012O1M	Either-sex, muzzleloader	100	307	Res 1 pt (36 of 53, 68%) / NonRes 8 pts (4 of 5, 80%)
EE012P1M	Either-sex, muzzleloader (private-land-only hunt code)	50	68	Res 0 pts (5 of 5) / NonRes 0 pts (29 of 42, 69%)
EF012O1M	Antlerless, muzzleloader	100	61	Drew at Choice 2 (Res 17 of 68, NonRes 16 of 37)
EF012O2R	Antlerless, 2nd rifle	1,500	442	Leftover – undersubscribed
EF012O3R	Antlerless, 3rd rifle	1,500	291	Leftover – undersubscribed
EF012P1M	Antlerless, muzzleloader (private-land-only code)	100	8	Leftover
EM012O4R	Bull, 4th rifle	500	157	Leftover – undersubscribed

Hunt-code letters follow CPW convention (E=either-sex, F=antlerless, M=antlered; O=all lands, P=private-land only; 1A archery, 1M muzzleloader, 2R–4R rifle seasons). Check the current CPW Big Game Brochure for each code's meaning, dates and OTC options. **Over-the-counter bull licenses are not in the draw recap**; their status for GMU 12 should be checked in the brochure.

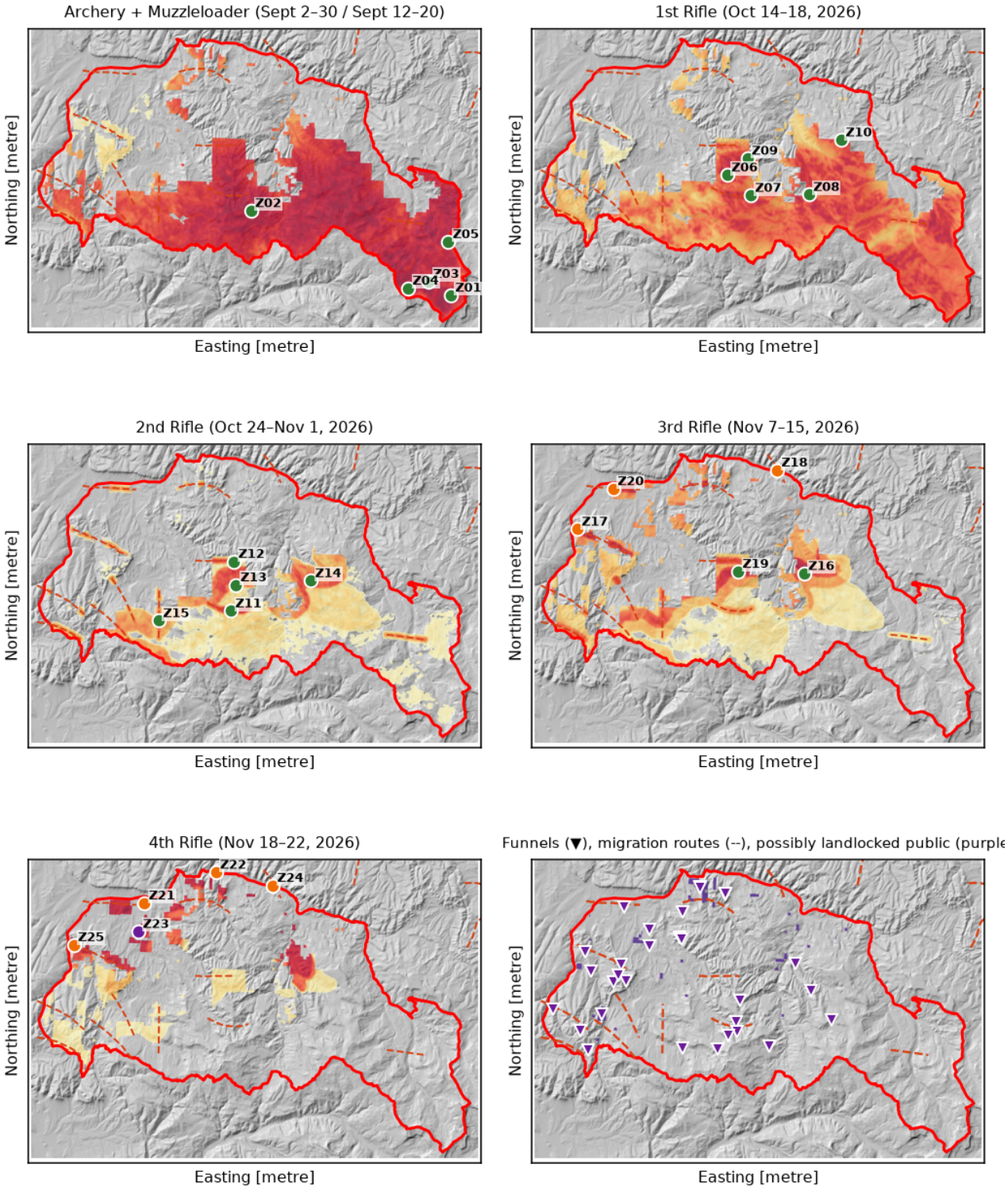
3. Harvest – 2025 Colorado Elk Harvest Estimates (CPW)

Hunt code	Bulls	Cows	Calves	Total harvest	Hunters	Success	Rec. days
EE012O1A (archery)	121	13	4	137	548	25.0%	3,811
EE012O1M (muzz.)	30	5	0	35	93	37.6%	401
EE012P1M (muzz., private)	15	4	0	20	44	45.5%	208
EM012O4R (bull 4th rifle)	67	0	0	67	321	20.9%	1,281
EF012O2R (cow 2nd rifle)	0	90	8	99	746	13.3%	3,668
EF012O3R (cow 3rd rifle)	0	28	12	40	520	7.7%	2,640
EF012O1M (cow muzz.)	0	8	0	8	99	8.1%	402
EF012P1M (cow muzz., private)	0	4	0	4	35	11.4%	115
DAU E-6 (all GMUs, all seasons)				4,321	21,819	20%	105,883

Estimates come from CPW's sample-based survey (DAU E-6 total 4,321 elk, 95% CI 4,084–4,572). Over-the-counter archery and 2nd/3rd rifle bull harvest is reported statewide (EM000U2R / EM000U3R) and is **not broken out for GMU 12** in this report, so it is not shown. Population estimates were not included in this sample.

4. Estimated hotspots by 2026 season

Heat = relative model score on federal land or CPW public-access property only. Dots = top zones, colored by the access check (green likely accessible, orange check, purple likely landlocked).



5. Top zones by season (estimates – 5 per season; muzzleloader uses archery zones)

Local maxima of each season score, ≥3 km apart, on federal land or CPW public-access property. WGS84 coordinates; also in GPX/KML. Starting points for glassing, not guarantees. Access check is a GIS screen, not a legal opinion.

ID	Season	Lat, Lon	Land / access check	Why (model inputs)
Z01	Archery Sept 2–30, 2026	40.05947, -107.15352	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; LANDFIRE canopy cover 65%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~30 m (NHD); ~9.5 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 5°, 10,655 ft
Z02	Archery Sept 2–30, 2026	40.15955, -107.48558	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 75%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~30 m (NHD); ~4.3 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 13°, 9,465 ft
Z03	Archery Sept 2–30, 2026	40.0762, -107.1907	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; LANDFIRE canopy cover 35%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~0 m (NHD); ~8.1 km from nearest mapped road; east/west-facing, slope 14°, 10,270 ft
Z04	Archery Sept 2–30, 2026	40.06699, -107.22392	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; LANDFIRE canopy cover 55%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~30 m (NHD); ~7.4 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 9°, 10,360 ft
Z05	Archery Sept 2–30, 2026	40.12693, -107.15984	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; LANDFIRE canopy cover 45%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~30 m (NHD); ~2.6 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 14°, 10,469 ft
Z06	1st Rifle Oct 14–18, 2026	40.20359, -107.53231	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 65%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~108 m (NHD); ~2.5 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 12°, 9,171 ft
Z07	1st Rifle Oct 14–18, 2026	40.17871, -107.49257	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; within 500 m of a CPW elk migration route; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 75%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~42 m (NHD); ~2.4 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 10°, 8,842 ft
Z08	1st Rifle Oct 14–18, 2026	40.1818, -107.39689	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; LANDFIRE canopy cover 65%; mapped water ~228 m (NHD); ~3.6 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 5°, 8,577 ft
Z09	1st Rifle Oct 14–18, 2026	40.22548, -107.49989	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter range; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 75%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~85 m (NHD); ~2.1 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 4°, 8,186 ft
Z10	1st Rifle Oct 14–18, 2026	40.25176, -107.34616	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; LANDFIRE canopy cover 65%; mapped water ~594 m (NHD); ~2.4 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 1°, 9,194 ft
Z11	2nd Rifle Oct 24–Nov 1, 2026	40.17787, -107.51876	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; on/next to a CPW elk migration route (<150 m); inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 75%; mapped water ~30 m (NHD); ~3.4 km from nearest mapped road; east/west-facing, slope 20°, 9,165 ft

ID	Season	Lat, Lon	Land / access check	Why (model inputs)
Z12	2nd Rifle Oct 24–Nov 1, 2026	40.24041, -107.51618	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter range; on/next to a CPW elk migration route (<150 m); inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 55%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~0 m (NHD); ~1.2 km from nearest mapped road; east/west-facing, slope 10°, 8,251 ft
Z13	2nd Rifle Oct 24–Nov 1, 2026	40.21101, -107.5116	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 65%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~120 m (NHD); ~2.6 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 18°, 8,860 ft
Z14	2nd Rifle Oct 24–Nov 1, 2026	40.2187, -107.38909	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 85%; mapped water ~60 m (NHD); ~1.9 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 24°, 8,729 ft
Z15	2nd Rifle Oct 24–Nov 1, 2026	40.1629, -107.63705	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter range; on/next to a CPW elk migration route (<150 m); inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 35%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~85 m (NHD); ~1.4 km from nearest mapped road; north-facing, slope 13°, 8,224 ft
Z16	3rd Rifle Nov 7–15, 2026	40.22745, -107.40689	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter concentration area; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 55%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~42 m (NHD); ~1.9 km from nearest mapped road; east/west-facing, slope 23°, 7,789 ft
Z17	3rd Rifle Nov 7–15, 2026	40.2751, -107.78145	BLM **CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)**	CPW elk summer range; CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; on/next to a CPW elk migration route (<150 m); inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 25%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~95 m (NHD); ~1.6 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 12°, 7,006 ft
Z18	3rd Rifle Nov 7–15, 2026	40.35702, -107.45567	BLM **CHECK – parcel group continues past the GMU line; access may exist outside the unit**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; within 500 m of a CPW elk migration route; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 0%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~90 m (NHD); ~0.6 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 10°, 6,477 ft
Z19	3rd Rifle Nov 7–15, 2026	40.22783, -107.51502	USFS **LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter range; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 65%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~60 m (NHD); ~2.6 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 13°, 8,457 ft
Z20	3rd Rifle Nov 7–15, 2026	40.3274, -107.72438	Iles Grove STL (CPW STL) **CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)**	CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; within 500 m of a CPW elk migration route; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 0%; mapped water ~108 m (NHD); ~1.5 km from nearest mapped road; east/west-facing, slope 4°, 6,306 ft
Z21	4th Rifle Nov 18–22, 2026	40.33008, -107.66703	Iles Grove STL (CPW STL) **CHECK – parcel group continues past the GMU line; access may exist outside the unit**	CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 0%; mapped water ~247 m (NHD); ~0.9 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 5°, 6,507 ft
Z22	4th Rifle Nov 18–22, 2026	40.37158, -107.55121	BLM **CHECK – parcel group continues past the GMU line; access may exist outside the unit**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 0%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~67 m (NHD); ~0.6 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 7°, 6,359 ft
Z23	4th Rifle Nov 18–22, 2026	40.29395, -107.67541	BLM **LIKELY LANDLOCKED – no mapped road/trailhead contact even with federal corner crossing**	CPW elk summer range; CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 0%; mapped water ~0 m (NHD); ~0.5 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 3°, 6,484 ft

ID	Season	Lat, Lon	Land / access check	Why (model inputs)
Z24	4th Rifle Nov 18–22, 2026	40.35701, -107.45637	BLM **CHECK – parcel group continues past the GMU line; access may exist outside the unit**	CPW elk summer concentration area; CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; within 500 m of a CPW elk migration route; inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 0%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~90 m (NHD); ~0.6 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 8°, 6,478 ft
Z25	4th Rifle Nov 18–22, 2026	40.27483, -107.78144	BLM **CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)**	CPW elk summer range; CPW elk winter concentration area; CPW severe winter range; on/next to a CPW elk migration route (<150 m); inside CPW elk migration corridor; LANDFIRE canopy cover 25%; timber/opening edge (feeding edge); mapped water ~67 m (NHD); ~1.6 km from nearest mapped road; south-facing, slope 13°, 6,976 ft

6. Access points

Trailhead (COTREX)	Lat, Lon
Transfer Trailhead	40.14181, -107.23485
Cyclone Trailhead	40.15209, -107.25351
East Fork Trailhead	40.15387, -107.2237
Morapos Trailhead	40.18981, -107.56154
Morapos Winter Trailhead	40.23074, -107.59353
Baldy Trailhead	40.16526, -107.21835
Elk Draw Trailhead	40.23385, -107.3776
Indian Run SWA East Trailhead	40.27003, -107.41742
Indian Run SWA Trailhead	40.27119, -107.4304

USFS MVUM roads: 36 routes (~48 mi) inside GMU 12, re-pulled in tiles. Census TIGER roads (~364 mi) were added for road-distance, but TIGER does not say whether a road is public. BLM route data are not included. Use the current printed or Avenza MVUM for the Routt / White River NF and check seasonal closures (big-game winter-range closures are common). CPW State Trust Land parcels are open only as CPW lists them (often hunting-season only, sometimes walk-in only).

7. Saddles, benches and water

From the USGS 3DEP DEM (~30 m) we flagged 40 saddle candidates (low points between higher ground, mathematically a saddle in the smoothed surface) and 30 benches (flat shelves inside steep slopes), on public land only. Water: 834 USGS NHD points (springs/seeps) and ponds/reservoirs/marshes on public land, plus perennial streams on the web map. NHD shows *mapped* water; stock tanks and springs can be dry in fall. NHD flowlines: 9248 segments. All are in the GPX/KML.

M. Migration & Seasons (new)

The herd. GMU 12 is one of 12 GMUs in CPW elk DAU E-6, the White River herd (GMUs 11, 12, 13, 23, 24, 25, 26, 33, 34, 131, 211, 231). CPW's current NW-region herd plan table lists E-6 with a population objective of 32,000–39,000 and a 2023 post-hunt estimate of ~30,380 elk at ~19 bulls/100 cows (CPW 2023 post-hunt estimates; NW elk HMP summary). CPW and partners describe the Bears Ears and White River herds as making some of Colorado's longest migrations, 60–70 miles each spring and fall, mostly east–west: summer range in the upper Yampa and White River drainages toward the Continental Divide, winter range west toward the Utah line (Colorado SO 3362 State Action Plan, Oct 2024).

Movement data found. (1) CPW migration routes, corridors and highway-crossing areas (CPWSpeciesData layers 33, 40, 34) – now drawn prominently on the map. CPW says its 2022 corridor analysis used 87 migrating GPS-collared E-6 elk and 75 E-2 elk, and that "some migration movements tend to occur quickly and with limited use of migratory stopovers" (SO 3362 plan, 2024). (2) A new CPW White River elk survival study started winter 2025–26 with 90 cows and 90 calves on 2-fixes-per-day collars; results are not public yet. (3) USGS Ungulate Migrations Vol. 5 maps the *White River mule deer* herd (not elk); I found no USGS-published White River or Bears Ears *elk* herd layer to download, and the USGS pages timed out from this computer. Raw collar data are not public. (4) USU thesis on White River cow elk (72 GPS elk) gives herd timing.

Timing (sourced). White River elk: spring migration ~Apr 15–Jun 20, calving May 15–Jun 20, **summer range ~Jun 16–Oct 14, fall migration to winter range ~Oct 15–Nov 30** (USU thesis citing USDA 2002). Rut: CPW says mating is over by mid-October; NPS (Rocky Mountain NP) puts peak rut mid-Sept to mid-Oct. Elevation: CPW describes the mountain-shrub zone (~6,500–8,500 ft) with its lower half as traditional elk winter range "in all but the most extreme winters", and sagebrush below ~6,500 ft as winter range (SO 3362 plan). **Snow/weather triggers:** sources describe fall movement as weather-driven, but I found no published, herd-specific snow-depth or date trigger for E-6, so none is assumed here.

2026 GMU 12 elk seasons (CPW 2026 Big Game Brochure, pp. 38–45, 52–56)

Season	2026 dates	GMU 12 licenses (hunt code)
Archery	Sept 2–30	Limited either-sex E-E-012-O1-A (valid 12, 23 N of White River, 24 N of N. Fork). GMU 12 is not on the OTC archery list. F
Muzzleloader	Sept 12–20	E-E-012-O1-M, cow E-F-012-O1-M; private-land-only E-E-012-P1-M, E-F-012-P1-M
1st rifle	Oct 14–18	Limited bull E-M-011-O1-R and cow E-F-011-O1-R (valid in 11, 12, 13, 23, 24, …); private-land-only either-sex E-E-011-P1-R
2nd rifle	Oct 24–Nov 1	OTC bull E-M-000-U2-R valid in GMU 12; limited cow E-F-012-O2-R
3rd rifle	Nov 7–15	OTC bull E-M-000-U3-R valid in GMU 12; limited cow E-F-012-O3-R
4th rifle	Nov 18–22	Limited bull E-M-012-O4-R; cow E-F-011-O4-R (valid 11, 12, 13, 23, 24, 211)
Private land only	Oct 1–Nov 30	Cow E-F-011-P5-R (11, 12, 13, 23, 24, 211)

Bulls in GMU 12 must have 4+ points on one antler or a 5-inch brow tine (brochure antler-point rule list). Always confirm on your license and in the current brochure.

Season-by-season movement timeline (estimates)

Season	Where elk likely are	What to target in this package	Confidence
Archery Sept 2–30 / Muzz Sept 12–20	Summer range and summer concentration areas, high basins and timber; peak rut	Archery zones; timber/opening edges near water; north slopes midday	High
1st rifle Oct 14–18	Migration typically just starting (~Oct 15); most still high, pushed into dark timber by pressure	1st-rifle zones: high canopy, north-facing, far from roads	Medium
2nd rifle Oct 24–Nov 1	Fall migration under way; using transition zones and corridors, can move fast with few stopovers	Corridors, routes, funnel/pinch points, saddles	Medium-low (snow-dependent)
3rd rifle Nov 7–15	Many moving down to winter-range edges; mild fall = still higher	Lower corridor segments, winter-range edge, cover near south slopes	Medium-low
4th rifle Nov 18–22	Normal winter: most on winter range/concentration areas, lower and south-facing	Winter-range zones (often BLM/state/private mix – check access)	Medium

Confidence reflects how well the herd timing source and CPW range maps match each window; it is not statistical. A big early storm can pull the whole timeline earlier; a dry, warm fall can push it later.

Corridor funnels and pinch points (estimates)

Funnel-Saddles = DEM saddles inside a CPW corridor or within 500 m of a CPW route. Funnel-Pinches = places inside a corridor where public land is narrow (under ~450 m half-width) with private land within ~600 m, so moving elk crossing public ground are squeezed. 30 were flagged (top 10 shown; all in GPX/KML).

Name	Lat, Lon	Elev (ft)	Access check
Funnel-Saddle 1	40.14212, -107.75784	7981	CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)
Funnel-Saddle 2	40.3521, -107.58307	7020	LIKELY LANDLOCKED – no mapped road/trailhead contact even with federal corner crossing
Funnel-Saddle 3	40.22503, -107.39456	8458	LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead
Funnel-Saddle 4	40.1486, -107.54529	9839	LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead
Funnel-Saddle 5	40.23036, -107.7002	7793	CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)
Funnel-Pinch 1	40.23837, -107.71311	7677	CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)
Funnel-Pinch 2	40.1667, -107.77282	8091	CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)
Funnel-Pinch 3	40.32011, -107.61058	6943	CHECK – touches a Census-mapped road (public/private status not verified)
Funnel-Pinch 4	40.25958, -107.42239	7134	LIKELY ACCESSIBLE – parcel group touches a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead
Funnel-Pinch 5	40.35133, -107.58164	7148	LIKELY LANDLOCKED – no mapped road/trailhead contact even with federal corner crossing

Legal-access screen (new)

Public land (federal + CPW properties) was grouped into parcel groups, allowing federal-to-federal corner connections (legal corner crossing) but not corners involving state land. Results: 1 group(s) / 223.2 sq mi touch a USFS MVUM road or COTREX trailhead (likely accessible); 26 groups / 32.6 sq mi touch only a Census TIGER road whose public status is unknown (check); 7 / 0.6 sq mi continue past the GMU line (check); 32 groups / 5.1 sq mi have no mapped contact (likely landlocked). This is a GIS screen at 30 m resolution, not a legal determination; county-road rights-of-way, easements and walk-in agreements are not in the data.

8. How the model works

Each 30 m cell on public land gets a weighted score per season, then smoothed (~120 m):

• **Early (Sept):** CPW summer concentration area (high weight), summer range, distance to mapped water (≤1.5 km), north-facing moderate slopes (timber/cover proxy), higher elevation, distance from MVUM roads (≥2 km best), recent burn (2020 Streeter fire, MTBS), benches/saddles.
• **Mid (Oct, transition):** modeled transition zone = within 1.5 km of the CPW winter-range edge or 500 m of a CPW elk migration route, plus migration-corridor polygons, cover proxy, distance from roads, water, burns, saddles/benches.
• **Late (Nov):** CPW winter concentration, winter range and severe winter range, south/west-facing gentle slopes, lower elevation, distance from roads, water.

v2 changes: cover now uses LANDFIRE 2024 canopy cover (30 m) plus a timber/opening feeding-edge term; six season models tied to 2026 CPW dates; road distance uses MVUM + Census TIGER. **Still not used:** BLM water developments, PAD-US/COMaP easements, BLM routes, snow and weather, hunting pressure data, and any GPS-collar data. Weights are expert-judgment guesses, not fitted to harvest or telemetry, so the scores are untested.

9. Legal notes (Colorado)

• **Corner crossing:** stepping corner-to-corner between two *federal* parcels without touching private ground is legal in Colorado per Iron Bar Holdings v. Cape (10th Cir. 2025; cert. denied Oct 20, 2025), as interpreted by the Colorado Attorney General. It does **not** apply to State Land Board/State Trust Land, SWAs, state parks or private land, and shooting across private land is trespass.
• **Scouting tech (CPW Ch. W-0, eff. May 1, 2026):** no drones to look for, scout or detect wildlife as an aid to hunting; no live-transmitting game cameras to locate game for taking that day or the next; no internet/computer-assisted remote hunting.
• **Ownership data is not a survey.** BLM SMA boundaries can be off by tens of meters; carry a current land-status app or map and respect posted signs.
• Follow MVUM motor-vehicle rules, seasonal road closures and CPW property-specific regulations.

10. Disclaimers

This is a sample product built automatically from public data. Hotspots are estimates, not animal sightings, and no information here guarantees elk presence, a license, or success. Draw and harvest figures are copied from CPW reports. Confirm everything against current CPW regulations before applying or hunting. Not legal advice. CPW data use in a commercial product still needs to be confirmed with CPW.

11. Data sources

Data	Source (accessed Oct 16, 2026)
GMU 12 boundary, CPW properties, trailheads, roads	CPW CPWAdminData FeatureServer (layers 6, 5, 14, 15): services5.arcgis.com/ttNGmDvKQA7oeDQ3/arcgis/rest/services/CPWAdminData/FeatureServer
Elk range/migration layers	CPW CPWSpeciesData FeatureServer layers 33 (routes), 34 (highway crossings), 35, 36, 40 (corridors), 41–44
2026 Primary Elk Draw Recap	CPW, via cpw.state.co.us/activities/hunting/big-game/hunting-elk/elk-statistics
2025 Elk Harvest Estimates	CPW, same page
Water	USGS NHD MapServer layers 0, 6, 12 (hydro.nationalmap.gov) – public domain
Land ownership	BLM National Surface Management Agency (gis.blm.gov, BLM_Natl_SMA_LimitedScale) – public domain
Roads	USFS EDW MVUM roads (apps.fs.usda.gov/arcx, EDW_MVUM_01) – partial
Elevation	USGS 3DEP ImageServer (elevation.nationalmap.gov), ~30 m – public domain
Canopy	LANDFIRE LF2024 Canopy Cover (lfps.usgs.gov ImageServer) – public domain
Other roads	US Census TIGERweb Local Roads (layer 8)
Herd/timing	CPW SO 3362 Colorado State Action Plan (wafwa.org, Oct 2024); USU thesis doi.org/10.26076/e2bb-b4a8; CPW NW elk HMP summary; CPW 2023 post-hunt estimates; CPW elk species page; NPS ROMO elk bugles page
Season dates	CPW 2026 Big Game Brochure; CPW 2025–2029 Big Game Season Structure
Burns	MTBS burned-area boundaries via USFS EDW_MTBS_01: Lost Lakes 2002 (5,888 ac), Streeter 2020 (1,817 ac)
Legal	CPW Ch. W-0 (Mar 2026); BHA/Colorado AG corner-crossing update; SCOTUS docket 25-64